Chapter 5: The Aftermath

I heard my alarm beep at me, so I woke up, put on my glasses, and looked to the clock. 6:30, as it said every morning, but this morning, I felt different. I slept like a baby for the first time since I started studying. I almost forgot what it felt like to get a good night's sleep from the many times I stayed in the lab overnight trying to get my experiments to work out, then did a full 10-hour teaching day, only to go back to the lab at night and start the whole cycle again. I only slept every couple of days, surviving mostly on cafeteria food, coffee and energy drinks. Surprisingly, I never liked coffee or energy drinks until I started researching. I didn't need any of that today though: the events of last night made it so I slept like a rock. I wondered if it was just that I was with Noah all night, or if what we did last night had anything to do with it. Either way, I liked the feeling.

The feeling subsided relatively quickly while my mind started racing with one thing I hadn't considered before. Since I was a professor, and since Noah was still a student, our relationship was sort of forbidden. *Would this affect my career? Will I still be able to teach?* I didn't know the answers to any of these questions, and it infuriated me. I didn't even know where to get them or who to ask, which infuriated me even more. I slowly worked my way out of the bed. I dressed myself with the clothes I took out before the party – but I needed a new shirt since I used the other one during our little adventure. Before I left the room, I saw Noah still laying there, curved in the position we cuddled in all night, completely naked. My mind instantly replayed the activities we did last night, and I felt myself starting to grin just like Noah did, before going back to the racing thoughts. I softly closed the door, trying not to wake him, and headed down the stairs to the kitchen to start preparing breakfast for the two of us.

Usually, I only made enough for myself, but I couldn't just leave him with nothing after all the fun we had, right? I decided to make the same thing I usually did: two eggs with some breakfast sausage, potato chunks, and toast, mostly because that's all I had for breakfast food except for cereal, and cereal wouldn't replace what we both lost last night. We needed something heartier. When I was about half done making everything, I heard Noah's steps as he slowly brought himself to the bottom of the stairs. As he appeared at the doorway leading to the kitchen, I saw he was wearing only his underwear from the previous night, which allowed his body to glisten in the early morning light coming through the kitchen window.

"Good morning, my sweet little bottom boy!" I joked with him.
"Good morning to you, my sexy, nerdy dom boyfriend!" he replied, his voice tired. "How can you have so much energy in the morning? Especially after last night?" he asked, as he rubbed his eyes and yawned.
"I don't really know… I think it has something to do with what we did, or just the fact that you were sleeping in the bed with me. Nonetheless, I think that was the best night of sleep I've ever had. How'd you sleep?"

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“I couldn’t sleep at first, after the excitement of our…” He paused, almost as if he was looking for something to describe what we did.
“Our incredible night of wild sex?” I confidently added.
“Sure, I was going for something a bit more PG-13, but that works too. I think after a while of feeling you hold on to me, I was able to fall asleep. I really liked that feeling – being held. But I kept dreaming about us – what we did – it just wouldn’t stop.”
“I could tell – I kind of couldn’t ignore it after you put my hand on your dick.”
He laughed, giving his face that signature grin. “Did you like it?” he asked romantically, like he wanted to relive the experience this morning.
“Of course I did – and by the number of times I felt it get hard throughout the night, you did too.”
“Yeah, you got me there…” he said, almost embarrassed. He paused for a few seconds. He looked like he had something to say but wasn’t sure how to say it. He started anyways, “I’ve been thinking about what we did last night too, and it made me realize something.”
“Oh yeah, what? Tell me!” I asked him, excited to know what he was thinking, and hoping that seeing me be excited for him would get him to feel safe enough to open up to me.

“Well, remember when I told you that I was bi? I’ve been thinking, especially after our – to use your words – incredible night of wild sex, that maybe that’s not the label I feel comfortable with using anymore.”
“What do you mean?” I asked him, sort of knowing what he meant already, but I wanted to help him realize it and come to terms with it in his mind.
“I mean… I don’t think I’m really bi. I think…” he hesitated, before finally saying the words: “I’m fully gay. Maybe I was just trying to keep up the ‘jock equals straight’ façade but being with you – it really opened my eyes, among other things,” he said with a wink.
“Noah, I’m so proud of you – thank you for feeling like you could tell me that,” I told him.
“Well, you did have your dick in me last night…” he said, jokingly,
“True…” I said, laughing with him. “It wasn’t my intention to turn you gay – you know that can’t happen, right?”
“Yeah, I know that. I think it’s been hiding inside me for so long. I always did like getting with guys more than getting with girls, so I think I’ve known for a while, but didn’t accept it until last night.”
“Well, I’m glad I was the person you were with when you came to accept yourself.” I told him.
“I am too, Cam, I am too,” he said.

I finished cooking the meal and prepared us both plates. As I brought them to the dining room table, Noah moved from the kitchen to the same spot he had last night at the party dinner: right next to me, but this time I could see much more of him, and I absolutely loved every inch. “Let’s eat – this looks beautiful, I can’t wait to see how good of a chef you are – if you’re half as good as you were in bed last night, I’ll never want to leave!” he said, so we started eating. All I could

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think about is how submissive he was. It didn't go with his personality. Not much of anything we did last night went with either of our personalities, but this – I just couldn't wrap my head around it. For some reason, my thoughts about our relationship being forbidden escaped my mind. Being with him always did have that affect on me – almost like my negative thoughts were afraid of his relentless positivity.

"I never would have pegged you as the submissive twink type." I said, catching what I said right after I said it, and almost instantly regretting it. "Sorry, did I say that out loud?" I stuttered, embarrassed, as I felt myself getting red in the face.
"You did, and boy, do you look *cute* when you're embarrassed. Three things though: You totally *did* peg me *a lot* last night, and I loved every second of it, I'm not a twink – I'm WAY to old and athletic to be a twink, and to answer the question you didn't intend to ask, it's a side of me that nobody really knows about. Only you – and you did a great job for your first time being dominant. I loved it, and I want more – all you can give me."
"Aww, thanks! It was definitely something I've never done before, and weirdly, I liked it too. I didn't think I would, but it was oddly freeing, and it felt nice being the one in control. One thing still confuses me though, why—" I started to say, as he interrupted.
"I spend most of my day being dominant on the rink, being a mentor for the other guys, I just… want to give up some control. I don't know why, but it's… just who I am," he said as he looked down to the floor, embarrassed by that side of himself.

I put two fingers under his chin – since he was right beside me, I could reach him – and lifted his head. "Well, I accept you for who you are," I told him while I took his hand in the hand that wasn't holding his head up. "I love who you are, and I never want you to change. Ever. You may be older and much more athletic than the stereotypical twink, but you're *my* twink, and I love you. I always have, and I always will. Nothing's ever going to change that." I lightly touched his nose, almost like he was a cat or dog, before I gingerly kissed him. I fought back the urge to say "boop!" as my finger touched his nose, but I think he would have liked it even more if I did.
I could see him start to blush when I said that he was my twink. I don't know why I said that, but it felt right, and it *was* accurate after all: he was mine, and I thought he looked like a twink, especially when I saw he was virtually hairless.

"Don't worry, your secret is safe with me," I reassured him.
"It damn well better be," he responded, quickly and sharply. "I've got a reputation to uphold, you know."
"What reputation? The closeted gay hockey star?"
"Well, when you put it that way, you make it sound like it's a bad thing. Don't you support me?" he asks, angrily.

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“Of course I do – that’s not—” I started to fumble. I had no intention on insulting him or his identity, especially since I went through that… quite a few times…. And I never liked it. *Did I just screw it up? Damn it, Cameron, why would you even say that?*
“I’m just joking, it’s not a big deal. You’ve got to stop taking everything so personally. It means a lot to me to have your support though. I’ll come out when I’m ready – I just don’t think I’m there yet,” he said, laughing.
“With you I can never tell when you’re serious and when you’re joking. I completely get it. I’ve been there too. Take your time: I’ll be there for you all the way, no matter how long it takes, no matter what.”
“Aww, thanks babe!” he said, giving me a small peck on the cheek. “I guess we both learned something about each other last night: you now know I’ve got a dom/sub kink, and I know you’re into femboys and that you’ve got a foot fetish. I wonder what other things we’ll discover… or *explore* together.”
“I guess you’re right… We’re *quite* the couple, aren’t we? Now that you mention it, here are a few things that I’d like to explore with you, especially after last night’s revelation…”
“Like what?”
“Well, you’ll have to wait to find out, but you’ll find out soon enough.”
“How *ominous* and dominant of you… I look forward to finding out.”

We kept eating, and suddenly I heard Noah ask “Hey, can we talk a bit more about what happened last night?”
“Sure – what’s on your mind?” I asked him.
“Are you open to some…” he paused for a few seconds before carefully saying, “constructive criticism?”
“I always am,” I answered.
“And I can be completely honest?”
“Of course.”
“While what I said last night was true – it was the best sex I’ve ever had – and while you did do what I wanted with the bondage, the domination… it was a bit much at times.”
“What makes you say that?” I asked.
“Well… I felt like I had no control at times. That’s fine for the bondage stuff, but outside of that, it was a bit much. It was more… *forced control* instead of *dominance*.”
“Alright, so you’re saying I’m a bad dom?”
“No, that’s not what I’m saying at all. I’m just saying you need a bit of improvement. That’s all.”
“Well, tell me then: how can I improve?”
“I’ll help you. The first few lessons are free, but you’ll need to earn the rest by doing well with the others. There will be a test, so pay attention,” he said, shooting me a wink. “You down for that?”
“Sure, if it’ll help me improve. You are the sexpert, after all.”

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“Lesson one: the dom/sub relationship is built on trust. While I *did* trust you last night, sometimes, I felt like I *couldn't*. Breaking that trust breaks the entire relationship. Does that make sense?”
“I guess so… If the sub can’t trust the dom, the relationship isn’t a good one. That sounds more toxic than anything.”
“Exactly!” he said excitedly.
“So how do I practice that?”
“Well, that’s not something I can teach you. The trust has to exist between the people in the relationship.”
“So, what does that mean for us? Do you trust me?”
“Sure, I do – but you’ll have to build on that trust a bit to become a better dom. I’ll let you figure out how to do that. Think of it as… a bit of homework,” he said, smiling at me and laughing.
“Alright… I’ll try and do my homework…” I said, laughing back at him. “So, what’s next?” I asked.

“Lesson two: The sub has the control,” he said as he reached onto my plate and stole a piece of toast. “It’s true that the dom controls the sub, but the sub has control over the entire scenario. The dom’s control has to fit within what the sub is willing to do – *you* control *me*, but *I* set the limits.”
“That makes sense… If the dom does something the sub doesn’t want to do, it breaks the trust, which breaks the relationship.”
“That’s absolutely right. Look at you applying concepts from the last lesson. You’re such a good student,” he joked.
“Well, I always was…” I played into it. “So, what can I do to allow you to control the situation?”
“Well,” he started, sipping his coffee, “Maybe instead of having an ‘I’m going to do this’ attitude, try making everything my decision. Or at least make *more* things my decision. There’s nothing wrong with you making decisions, but I should be making some too. It’s not just your moment: we’re *both* sharing it. That’s the kind of relationship I’d like to have. Try and frame things in a way that makes me *choose* to do it, rather than you just *taking* what you want. Make me crave it so much that doing it becomes my idea. Make sense?”
“Sure, I’ll try to make sure you have more control going forward… that is, if you’ll let me dom you again…”
“You’re already getting it: that’s a perfect example. Of course I’ll let you,” he said, kissing me slightly.
“Anything else?” I asked, interested.
“Adding safe words is common. I’ve seen people use ‘red’ to mean absolutely not, no more, we’re done here, and ‘yellow’ to mean I’m getting a bit uncomfortable here – continue but be careful.”
“We can do that… What would be most comfortable for you?”

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“Let’s stick to the traffic light system for now. We can always change them later. The important part is that any time you hear the safe words – regardless of context – you acknowledge it and take the appropriate action. Red: stop. Yellow: maybe tone it down a bit or check in. You can always ask me for guidance if you’re unsure.”
“Got it.”
“We can even use ‘green’ to mean yes, keep going, I like it… but something tells me we won’t need that one – at least in the bedroom,” he said as winked at me again.
“I think you’re right there. Your… let’s just say… *vocalizations* tell me enough about that,” I said, laughing and shooting him a wink back. He smiled nervously back at me. “What’s next for me to learn?”

“It’s not really about the sex; it’s about the mindset. B/D/S/M is often *applied to* sex, but it’s not *about* sex. Good doms can be dominant without ever touching their sub. Earlier, you said ‘You’ll have to wait, but you’ll find out soon enough’ – that’s perfect domination. You controlled the story… my emotions… *me*… without even touching me. It made me tingly inside – that’s how good it was. That’s how it’s supposed to go.”
“Got it, so more of that sort of thing… I guess you could call it *passive control*?”
“Well… not quite. You *are* still in control, just in a different way. Let me try and explain using science… Think of it like kinetic and potential energy.”
“How does physics even remotely relate to this?” I asked, turning my head a bit.
“Well… kinetic energy is the energy of movement, right?” he asked, eating some of his eggs.
“Yeah…”
“That’s like what we did last night: the bondage, the teasing, the foreplay, the sex… basically everything physical. Are you with me so far?”
“Sure…”
“Okay, and potential energy is energy that is built up based on the situation, right?”
“Right…”
“That’s like what we’re talking about: everything that *isn’t* physical. The build-up, the anticipation, the emotional control… It’s like you’re holding a ball at the top of a hill – it’s not moving yet, but the energy is still there. You haven’t *done* anything yet, but I should feel the weight of what you *might* do. That’s what was missing.”
“So, you’re saying… I should focus on the entire situation… the work, not just the impact?”
“I don’t know much more physics, but that sounds about right,” he said, laughing. “You don't need to be doing something to be in charge. You just focus on being the hill. I’ll be your ball… just waiting for you to decide when I get to roll. Let the energy convert itself.”
“That… actually makes sense. Is there anything else I should think about?”

“Okay, this is your last free one: Aftercare is always important after a dom/sub interaction,” he started, having a bit more of his breakfast, “especially if it’s intense, sexual, or both – like last night. I like to feel like I’m special after I’ve been dominated. You’re already crushing it with

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this one. The cuddling and the breakfast are perfect examples of aftercare, so there isn't much to improve here. Maybe if you're interested, look at a few other things you could do to broaden your aftercare horizons."
"So, more homework?"
"Of course – I *am* that kind of teacher, but this sort of homework will help you more than any you've ever done, if you catch my drift," he said, giving me another wink.
"Thanks for teaching me – I'll try to be better going forward."
"I know last night was your first time, so that's all I want: I want you to *learn* and *improve*, just like you do with your students. I've been through this part, and I didn't have someone who was able to teach me this stuff like you do. Thanks for being open to the criticism and for being active in the discussion. Most people wouldn't be either of those things."
"I've definitely learned a lot… and I look forward to doing that homework and applying my new knowledge."
"That's the spirit! I look forward to *grading* that homework too," he said as we both laughed a bit.

Right after we finished eating our breakfast, we head back to the kitchen to put the dishes away.
"Hey, don't forget I have my suicide intervention training today and tomorrow – so you probably won't see me on campus at all, and I'll probably be home late. If you don't want to go back to your dorm, you can always stay here, if you want to." I told him.
"Anything beats that small room, I'd much rather stay here if I can. After all, you're here."
"Sure – I'll get a key made for you on my way to campus today – I'll text you during our lunch break for you to get it. If you want, you could live here and just come to campus with me every day, since I'm there pretty much all day, every day." I paused, and my mind instantly went into overdrive. *Did I really just ask him to move in with me? After one night of passionate lovemaking? With no real relationship? Why did I say that?* "Unless—" I started again.
"I think I'd like that. I'll bring my things with me tonight, if that's okay with you."
"Of course. What's mine is yours, I guess." I told him.
"And based on last night, what's mine is yours too," he shot right back at me, with that grin on his face, winking at me.

"One more thing… I was thinking this morning about what we did last night and how it fits into our roles at the university – I think our relationship is sort of forbidden."
"Why would you say that?"
"You know, because of the whole professor-student thing? It's kind of a problem if I date a student, even if I never end up teaching you."
"Well, we don't have to tell anyone—" he started to say before I frantically interrupted him.
"Of course we do! If someone finds out, and I didn't report it, I could lose the job I've worked so hard to get. The job I love. I'd be virtually unhireable anywhere in the field of education."
"Well, who are you going to tell?"

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“I… I don’t know, I haven’t gotten that far yet.”
“When you do, tell me. I want to be there with you. I want to make sure whoever you’re telling knows it’s consensual and that I have no academic benefit from it. I’ll do whatever it takes to protect you and your career – I know how hard you’ve worked to get here, and I don’t want to ruin it.”
“Aww, you’re always so sweet – I love that about you.” I told him as I put my hand on his face, caressing it softly. “Anyways, I’d better get going – I don’t want to be late to the training after I get your key.”
“Oh yeah, wouldn’t want that,” he said, joking with me. “Can I at least get a little somethin’ before you leave?”
“Well, that depends – a few minutes of passionate kisses, absolutely. I’ll always make some room for that. Sex, probably not enough time for that.” I joked with him.
“I meant a kiss goodbye, you dumb nerd,” he joked right back.
“Well, how’s this then?” I asked him as I pulled him close and began to kiss him. I slid my hand to his upper back and bent him backwards, still kissing him, almost like I was dipping him in a dance, before bringing him back up again, hugging him tightly, and leaving the house to start my day.
“That’s why I love you! Have a good day of training, mon petit doudou!” he said, loudly, but not yelling, and romantically at the same time.

I blew him a kiss through the window of my car as I started to leave. I saw him pretend to catch it and hold it close to his heart before blowing me one too. *He thinks I’m his little cuddle toy? Accurate.* Hearing him speak French ignited the same flame I had for him the night prior. It made my heart melt. He knew I liked it when he speaks French. Maybe that’s something I might have to use on him in the future. As promised, I went to the hardware store on my way to campus to have a key cut for him. It was on my way to campus anyways, so it wasn’t much of an inconvenience for me. Once I had it, I headed the rest of the way to campus. The entire time, all I could think of was how forbidden my relationship with Noah was, despite how much I liked it – despite how much we both wanted it. I didn’t want to tell anyone, but I knew it was the right thing to do if I didn’t want to lose my job, which I definitely didn’t. Who to tell was still a mystery: I mean, who could I tell – this isn’t something you hear every day. *Hey, I’m sleeping with a student – is that fine?* just doesn’t come up in regular conversations. I would have to tell the right person to avoid being judged – not only for having a relationship with a student but also being in a relationship with another guy. Sure, I was openly gay to *some* of my colleagues, but most of the university didn’t know – especially the administration.

The invitation to the training said that it was on the third floor of the science building, which I was all too familiar with. I did most of my research in that building after all, so I knew I could navigate it without any issues. I found the training room at the end of the hallway. In the room was a table containing a stack of medium-sized workbooks – which I assumed was what we’d be

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using to take notes – along with a pile of lanyards. Half of the lanyards were blue, and the other half were purple. Each lanyard had a paper inside a pocket, on which were written our names. I was about 30 minutes early, so nobody was there, including the instructors, whose names were written on the white board: Janet S. and Gina P. I found a seat – of course I picked the seat in the center of the first row. I always liked being in the first row since it helped me see the material being taught. Not to mention it usually meant I'd be more likely to be able to ask questions, and I'd be asked to answer questions – which was my favourite part of the learning process. I've always been a kinesthetic learner, so doing things and asking about something helped me learn it better than writing notes and reviewing them later. Of course, I always did take notes and review them, but actually doing things – handling chemicals, writing code – is the part that really helped me flourish. I decided to go on my phone while I was waiting.

Shortly after, maybe about ten minutes after I sat down, I saw Dr. Browne enter the room. I wondered if she'd have any insight into my situation with Noah and who to tell about it. I wasn't about to start talking about my forbidden romance with a student in the open in case others in the training started to arrive, so I asked her if we could talk over the lunch break, to which she agreed. I sent a text to Noah that said, "Lunch at 12:30, meet me in the café on the fourth-floor mezzanine of the science building – Dr. Browne is going to have lunch with us so we can discuss our situation." Within a few seconds, I saw the check icon next to the message get filled in, telling me he read it. Seconds later, I got a message back, only containing a thumbs-up emoji. Dr. Browne and I got to talking, so I didn't notice the others in the training begin to funnel in.

"Good morning, everyone and welcome to NOIT's suicide intervention training. My name is Gina, and this is Janet. We both work in the Office of Student Wellness. Before we begin, I would like to thank everyone here for their interest in keeping our students safe. I will be honest with you: this training module will be long and at times emotionally involved. If you need a break, you are always welcome to take one," Gina started.
"This training is a mix of content and application – we'll do mostly content today as a group and break into smaller workgroups to do some reflections and a little bit of practice. Tomorrow will be the opposite: mostly practice, but we'll do a small bit of content in the morning. The colour of your lanyard represents which workgroup you're in. The blue workgroup will be led by me, and the purple one will be led by Janet." Janet continued. I looked through the room, and I could see the sea of blue and purple lanyards around people's necks, in no particular order. I looked over to Dr. Browne, who is wearing a blue lanyard, before I looked at my own. Also blue. I instantly felt a bit better about the training, which I had some worry about all morning, which was all overshadowed by my concerns about my relationship with Noah.

Eventually, Gina and Janet started the content of our morning. It's too much to tell, but it covered information about the organization we're training through, the indications of suicide and how to detect them, and the general steps we go through to help someone in need. Before long, it was

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time for lunch, and both Dr. Browne and I headed up to the café to meet with Noah. I guess time flies when you don’t pay attention to it.

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